

The training was given as part of the OSCE's 'Capacity-building on countering cybercrime in Central Asia' initiative, which was carried out by the OSCE Transnational Threats Department in close collaboration with OSCE field operations in the region. The goal is to develop long term national cybercrime training capacities for police personnel and prosecutors.

Two 'train the trainers' courses and topical training courses on managing digital evidence by first responders, as well as investigating crimes enabled by the usage of Dark Web and virtual currencies, were delivered this year.

Kickstarter to support development of new open source protocol

Kickstarter has announced that it is going support the development of an open source protocol that will essentially create a decentralised version of Kickstarter's core functionality. This will live on a public blockchain, and be available for collaborators, independent contributors, and even Kickstarter competitors, from all over the world to build upon, connect to, or use.

"We've chosen Celo, an open source and carbon negative blockchain platform, as the best technology and community on which to build the protocol. We're inspired by the Celo ecosystem's approach to building the technology they want



to see in the world," said a company spokesperson.

An autonomous organisation to kickstart protocol development will be set up. Kickstarter PBC will fund this new independent

company, select an initial board of directors, and commit to being one of the protocol's first clients. This means Kickstarter.com will be constructed on top of the protocol. Users will continue to have the same Kickstarter experience that they are used to. Although they will not be able to see the protocol, they will benefit from the improvements that will be made.

There is still a lot of work to be done on this project. Kickstarter also intends to establish a governance lab, which will be separate from both the existing and new companies, and provide independent governance for the protocol. The purpose of creating yet another separate corporation is to prevent Kickstarter from exerting undue influence over what is supposed to be a mostly decentralised operation.

Linux Foundation to host the Cloud Hypervisor project

The Linux Foundation has announced it will host the Cloud Hypervisor project, which delivers a virtual machine monitor for modern cloud workloads. Written in Rust with a strong focus on security, its features include CPU, memory and device hot plug; support for running Windows and Linux guests; device offload with vhost-user; and a minimal and compact footprint.

In an official announcement, the Foundation said the project is supported by Alibaba, ARM, ByteDance, Intel, Microsoft, and many others. The focus of the project will initially be on security and modern operation for the cloud.

"Cloud Hypervisor has grown to the point of moving to the neutral governance of The Linux Foundation," said Arjan van de Ven, Intel fellow and founding technical sponsor for the project. "We created the project to provide a more secure and updated VMM to optimise for modern cloud workloads. With fewer device

Critical vulnerability found in open source tool Apache Log4j

A recently discovered cybersecurity vulnerability in Apache Log4j, an open source software program used by a considerable number of enterprises, could potentially allow hackers to install malware on impacted systems. Security specialists from around the world have raced to fix this vulnerability which is being deemed as one of the worst computer flaws in many years — a serious hole in open source code that is used widely in cloud services and corporate software by industry and government.



The Apache Software Foundation, which supervises Log4j development, has released a patch for this newly discovered flaw and hopes to have this issue fixed as soon as possible. If downloading the patch isn't possible anyhow, the organisation has also provided the required guidelines on how users might avoid this flaw. Users have been asked to deploy the patch to the affected systems right away by the US Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency.

Log4j comes with several prominent open source programs managed by the Apache Software Foundation, and the vulnerability poses a very significant cybersecurity risk. These tools help to power a large number of apps around the world, many of which may now be more vulnerable as a result of this flaw. Apple Inc.'s iCloud cloud storage service and Microsoft Corp.'s popular Minecraft video game are thought to be among the affected products.